

COMPLETE TRAVEL GUIDE

熊野古道 Kumano Kodo & Kyoto

Two days on the pilgrim trail through the Kii mountains, bookended by Kyoto's shrines and a night in a river onsen.

WHEN
8 Apr – 12 Apr 2027

LENGTH
5 days · 4 nights

WHO
2 adults

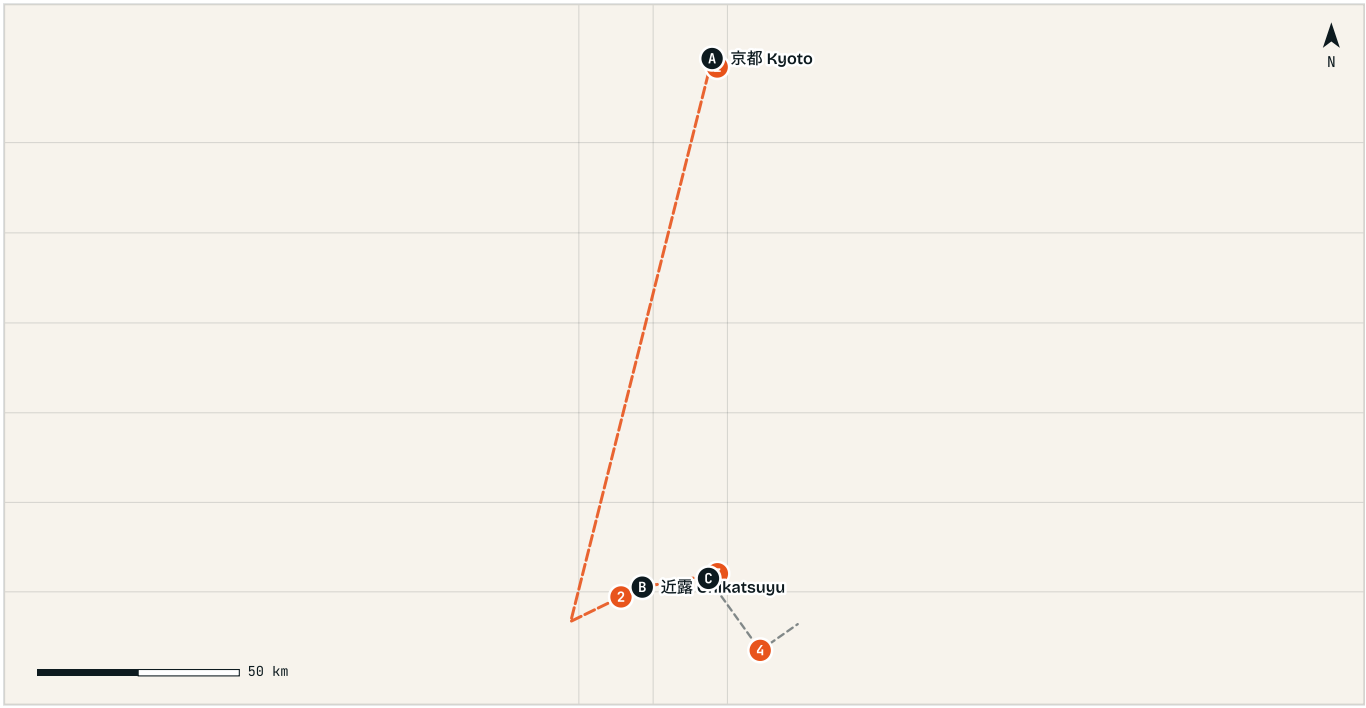
ROUTE
京都 Kyoto → 近露 Chikatsuyu → 湯の峰温泉 Yunomine Onsen

Planned with Sidequest · 12 November 2026
All times are local (JST, Asia/Tokyo)
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TRIP AT A GLANCE

The shape of the trip

DAYS	STAYS	STOPS	ON FOOT
5	3	12	≈ 26 km



Letters are where you sleep; numbers are the day each stop falls on. Solid lines follow measured routes; dashed lines are straight connections, not roads.

Where you sleep

- A **京都 Kyoto** · 1 night · Thu 8 Apr – Fri 9 Apr
- B **近露 Chikatsuyu** · 1 night · Fri 9 Apr – Sat 10 Apr
- C **湯の峰温泉 Yunomine Onsen** · 2 nights · Sat 10 Apr – Mon 12 Apr

Getting around

Trains and the Ryūjin and Meikō buses; no car is needed and the trail sections are on foot.

Built around

熊野古道 中辺路 Nakahechi · Day 2
The classic two-day walk between the trail's entrance and the Grand Shrine.

熊野本宮大社 Kumano Hongū Taisha · Day 3

那智の滝 Nachi Falls · Day 4

DAY BY DAY

5 days

Times are local (JST). A time marked ≈ follows a journey estimated from the map; a part of the day stands in where a journey could not be timed.

DAY

1

Thursday 8 April · 京都 Kyoto · Light day · 50 min on the move

Arrive and walk the shrine gates at dusk

14:00 **1 京都駅 Kyoto Station** · 30 min
Leave bags at the hotel near the station; trains south leave from here tomorrow.

JR Nara Line to Inari · 6 min

15:15 **2 伏見稲荷大社 Fushimi Inari-taisha** · 2 hr
The gates thin out after the Yotsutsuji crossroads, about forty minutes up.

Keihan Line to Kiyomizu-Gojō · ≈ 20 min

≈ 18:00 **3 清水寺 Kiyomizu-dera** · 1 hr 15 min
Evening opening in spring; the stage faces west over the city.

≈ 19:30 Dinner in 先斗町 Pontochō

NOTE Spring evening openings change year to year; check the temple's own calendar the week before.

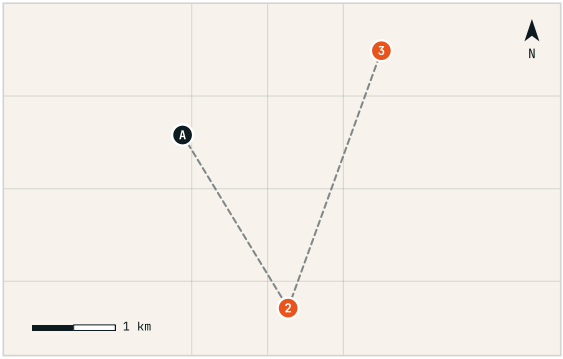




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DAY 2

Friday 9 April · 近露 Chikatsuyu · Full day · 3 hr 30 min on the move

Down to the Kii Peninsula and onto the Nakahechi trail

Moving on: 京都 Kyoto → 近露 Chikatsuyu

Limited express Kuroshio to 紀伊田辺 Kii-Tanabe · 2 hr 50 min
Ryūjin bus to 滝尻 Takijiri · 40 min

11:30 **1 滝尻王子 Takijiri-ōji** · 20 min
The traditional entrance to the sacred mountains; the climb starts steeply behind the shrine.

≈ 12:00 **2 熊野古道 中辺路 Nakahechi: Takijiri → Chikatsuyu** · 6 hr Book ahead
About 13 km of forest trail and stone steps; carry lunch, there is nowhere to buy it.

≈ 18:30 Dinner at the minshuku (included)

NOTE Luggage transfer to Chikatsuyu must be booked two days ahead with the Kumano Travel desk.

PLAN B Heavy rain: take the bus to 近露 Chikatsuyu and walk the short loop to 箸折峠 Hashiori-tōge instead.

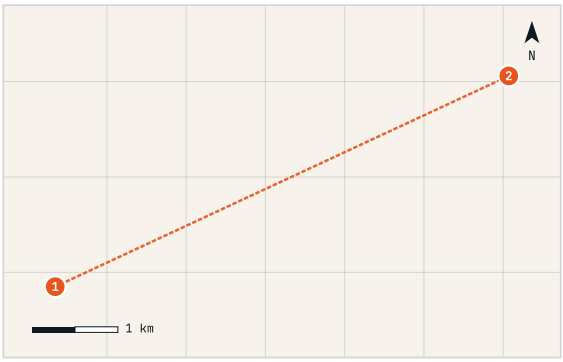




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DAY 3

Saturday 10 April · 湯の峰温泉 Yunomine Onsen · Full day · 15 min on the move

The long day to the Grand Shrine

Moving on: 近露 Chikatsuyu → 湯の峰温泉 Yunomine Onsen

07:30 **1 近露 → 発心門王子 Hosshinmon-ōji** · 5 hr
Bus the first section if your legs are tired; the final 7 km are the most beautiful.

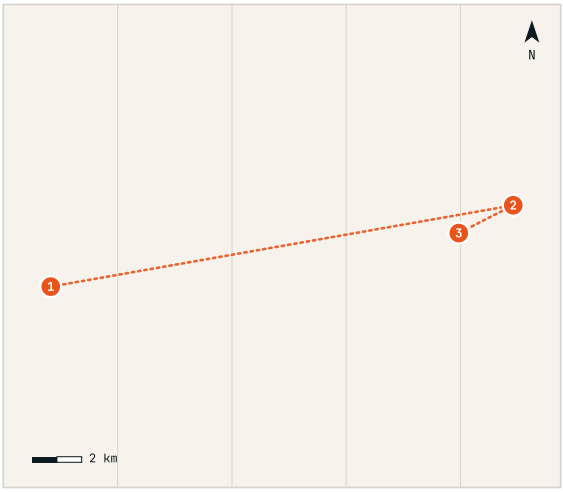
≈ 13:30 **2 熊野本宮大社 Kumano Hongū Taisha** · 1 hr 30 min
Walk on to 大斎原 Ōyunohara, the old shrine site, under the largest torii in Japan.

Bus to 湯の峰温泉 Yunomine Onsen · ≈ 15 min

≈ 16:00 **3 つぼ湯 Tsuboyu** · 30 min Timed entry
A one-family cabin bath in the river; take a numbered ticket at the shop.

≈ 18:30 Kaiseki dinner at the ryokan (included)

PLAN B Bus all the way to 本宮 Hongū and spend the afternoon at the shrine and the onsen.



DAY 4

Sunday 11 April · 湯の峰温泉 Yunomine Onsen · Moderate day · 3 hr 20 min on the move

Nachi Falls and the coast

Bus to 那智山 Nachisan via 新宮 Shingū · 1 hr 50 min

10:30 **1 大門坂 Daimon-zaka** · 45 min
Six hundred metres of cedar-lined stone stairs up to the shrine.

11:30 **2 那智の滝 Nachi Falls** · 1 hr 30 min
The three-storey pagoda frames the 133 m fall; the classic view is from the path below it.

≈ 13:00 Lunch: maguro-don in 勝浦 Katsuura

≈ 15:00 **3 熊野速玉大社 Kumano Hayatama Taisha** · 45 min

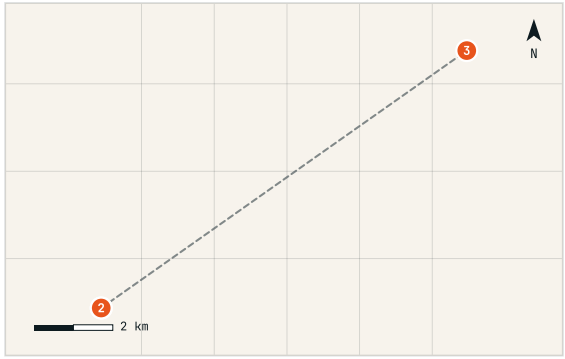




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DAY 5

Monday 12 April · 湯の峰温泉 Yunomine Onsen · Light day · 4 hr 30 min on the move

Back to Kyoto

Bus to 紀伊田辺 Kii-Tanabe · 1 hr 40 min
Limited express Kuroshio to 京都 Kyoto · 2 hr 50 min

≈ 15:00 Time in Kyoto before your onward journey

ACCOMMODATION & TRANSPORT

Where you sleep, and how you move

STAY	NIGHTS	DATES	STATUS
京都 Kyoto 京都駅 near Kyoto Station Trains south to the peninsula leave from the station.	1	Thu 8 Apr – Fri 9 Apr	BOOKED Hotel near Hachijō exit
近露 Chikatsuyu The end of the first trail day; minshuku dinners are included.	1	Fri 9 Apr – Sat 10 Apr	TO BOOK
湯の峰温泉 Yunomine Onsen A short bus from the Grand Shrine, with the river bath on the doorstep.	2	Sat 10 Apr – Mon 12 Apr	TO BOOK

Getting around

Trains and the Ryūjin and Meikō buses; no car is needed and the trail sections are on foot.

- Buses on the peninsula run a few times a day; the last one from Hongū leaves in the late afternoon.
- Send luggage ahead with the Kumano Travel transfer instead of carrying it on the trail.

Moving between stays

DAY	FROM	TO	HOW
2	京都 Kyoto	近露 Chikatsuyu	Rail, bus and trail · ≈ 9 hr
3	近露 Chikatsuyu	湯の峰温泉 Yunomine Onsen	Trail and bus · ≈ 7 hr

BOOKINGS & PREPARATION

Before you go

What to book

ITEM	WHEN	WHAT TO DO	STATUS
近露 Chikatsuyu minshuku Essential	Fri 9 Apr	Reserve through Kumano Travel; rooms in the village are few.	TO BOOK
湯の峰温泉 Yunomine ryokan Essential	Sat 10 Apr	Reserve two nights with dinner.	TO BOOK
Luggage transfer Recommended	Fri 9 Apr	Book two days ahead with the Kumano Travel desk. By Wed 7 Apr	TO BOOK
Limited express Kuroshio Recommended	Fri 9 Apr	Reserve seats from Kyoto to Kii-Tanabe.	BOOKED

To do before you leave

- [ ] Download the Kumano Kodo trail map for offline use.
- [ ] Carry cash: many minshuku and buses take yen only.
- [ ] Get a Suica or ICOCA card for trains in Kyoto.

Packing

FOOTWEAR

- [ ] Broken-in trail shoes
- [ ] Sandals for the ryokan

WEATHER

- [ ] Rain shell
- [ ] Pack cover

ESSENTIAL DOCUMENTS

- [ ] Passport
- [ ] Rail reservations

PRACTICAL REFERENCE

Keep this page handy

EMERGENCY **110**

The general emergency number in Japan (119 for fire and ambulance). Confirm locally; reference facts compiled by Sidequest.

DRIVING
On the left

MONEY
JPY

PLUGS
Type A, B · 100 V

CALLING CODE
+81

TIME ZONE
JST · Asia/Tokyo

Scan to open

Read-only copy for companions
Anyone with this link can read the plan.
`sidequest.example/share/fixtureJapanToken123`

Day 3 in Google Maps
3 stops, in order

Day 2 in Google Maps
2 stops, in order

APPENDIX

Planning notes and reference

How this plan was put together

The trail days are placed mid-trip so a late arrival or a jet-lagged first morning never falls on a mountain.

Kyoto is one night only: the trip is built around the peninsula.

Positions

Type a pair into any map app's search box.

1	伏見稲荷大社 Fushimi Inari-taisha	34.96710, 135.77270
2	滝尻王子 Takijiri-ōji	33.78850, 135.51350
3	熊野本宮大社 Kumano Hongū Taisha	33.84020, 135.77310
4	那智の滝 Nachi Falls	33.66870, 135.88890

Credits

Photo · 大斎原 Ōyunohara torii: Douglas Perkins, CC BY 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons
Photo · 伏見稲荷大社 Fushimi Inari-taisha: Basile Morin, CC BY-SA 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons
Photo · 熊野古道 Kumano Kodo stairs: VKaeru, CC BY-SA 3.0, via Wikimedia Commons
Photo · 那智の滝 Nachi Falls: Zairon, CC BY 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons
Test fixture: hand-written for rendering checks.